



ASTRO HOTEL PASADENA – USABILITY STUDY

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AGENDA

- Welcome to Astro Hotel
- Research Plan
- User's Mental Models
- Usability Insights

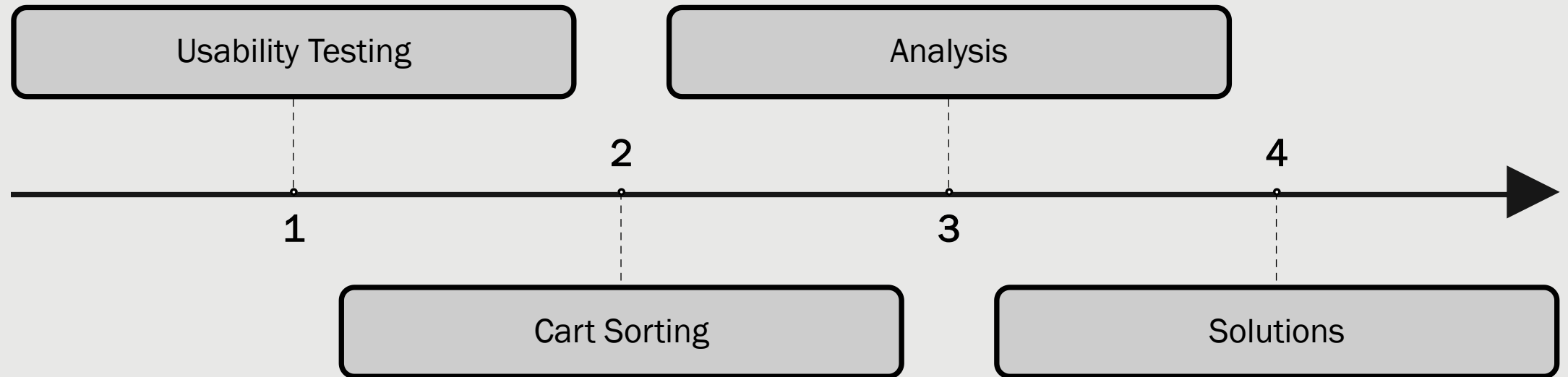
WELCOME TO ASTRO-HOTEL



- Located in Pasadena, Astro is a retro hotel with a modern touch.
- Modeled after the Googie architecture style that was popular in the 1950s, each room offers a unique experience with modern amenities.
- Thematically, think futuristic, space, or the Jetson's.

RESEARCH PLAN

- Goal – Uncover usability issues and improve experience for both web and mobile users
- Conduct Task-Based Usability Testing
- 5 Users / 6 Tasks
- In-person desktop and mobile



USER DEMOGRAPHICS

- Age range: Mostly young adults, mid 20s
- Mostly working professionals
- High internet usage
- Very comfortable with technology

USERS	AGE	JOB	INTERNET USE	PRIMARY INTERNET USE
Mikey	26	Stagehand at children's theater company	High, > 60 hrs/wk	YouTube; TikTok; socializing with friends
Alex	26	New patient coordinator at a dental office	High, all the time	Wiki, Twitter, YouTube; watch shows, movies, look up info
Alexander	37	Caregiver and HVAC student	High, everyday	Homework, YouTube, social media, Spotify, Google, Google AI
Paulette	27	Secretary at a tax agency	High, 40+ hrs/wk	Shopping, Amazon, Old Navy, JCPenny.
Efrain	60	Retired	High, 6+ hours/day	Watching videos on YouTube

TOP HIGHLIGHTS

- Navigation
- Booking Process
- Information Inconsistency / Clarity

POSITIVES	AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT
Every user understood website's purpose	Booking Process - Booking multiple different rooms is not possible
Users were able to find information they needed	Lack of Clarity - Hotel Policies / Terms & Conditions
Successful Task Completion - Contact Hotel – Pass - Read reviews – Pass - Find pictures and amenities – Pass - Navigate to ‘Nearby Attractions’ – Pass - Book 1 room - Pass	Information Architecture - Nearby Attractions - Gallery - Navigation

GENERAL FINDINGS

Mismatched mental models

Booking multiple rooms does not match user expectations

Pictures are important

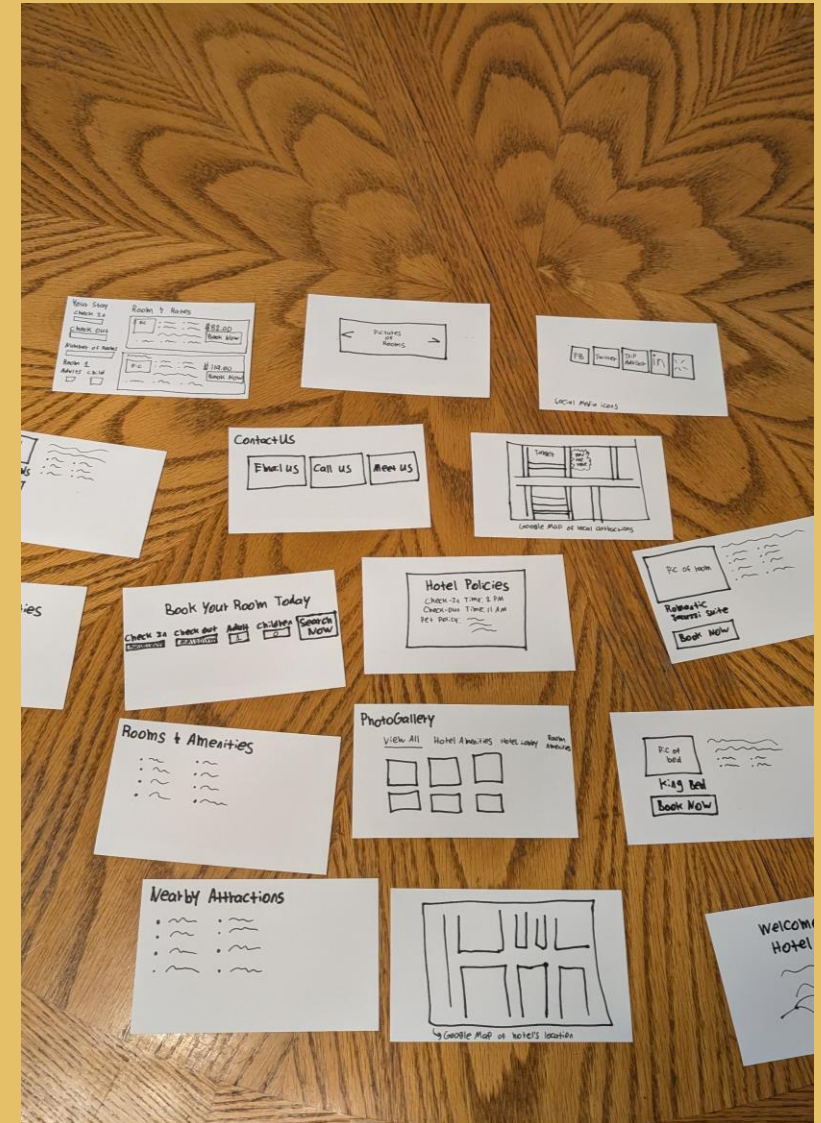
Navigation flow breaks in key areas

Users think visually about distance/locations

The ability to speak to a person is important

CARD SORT

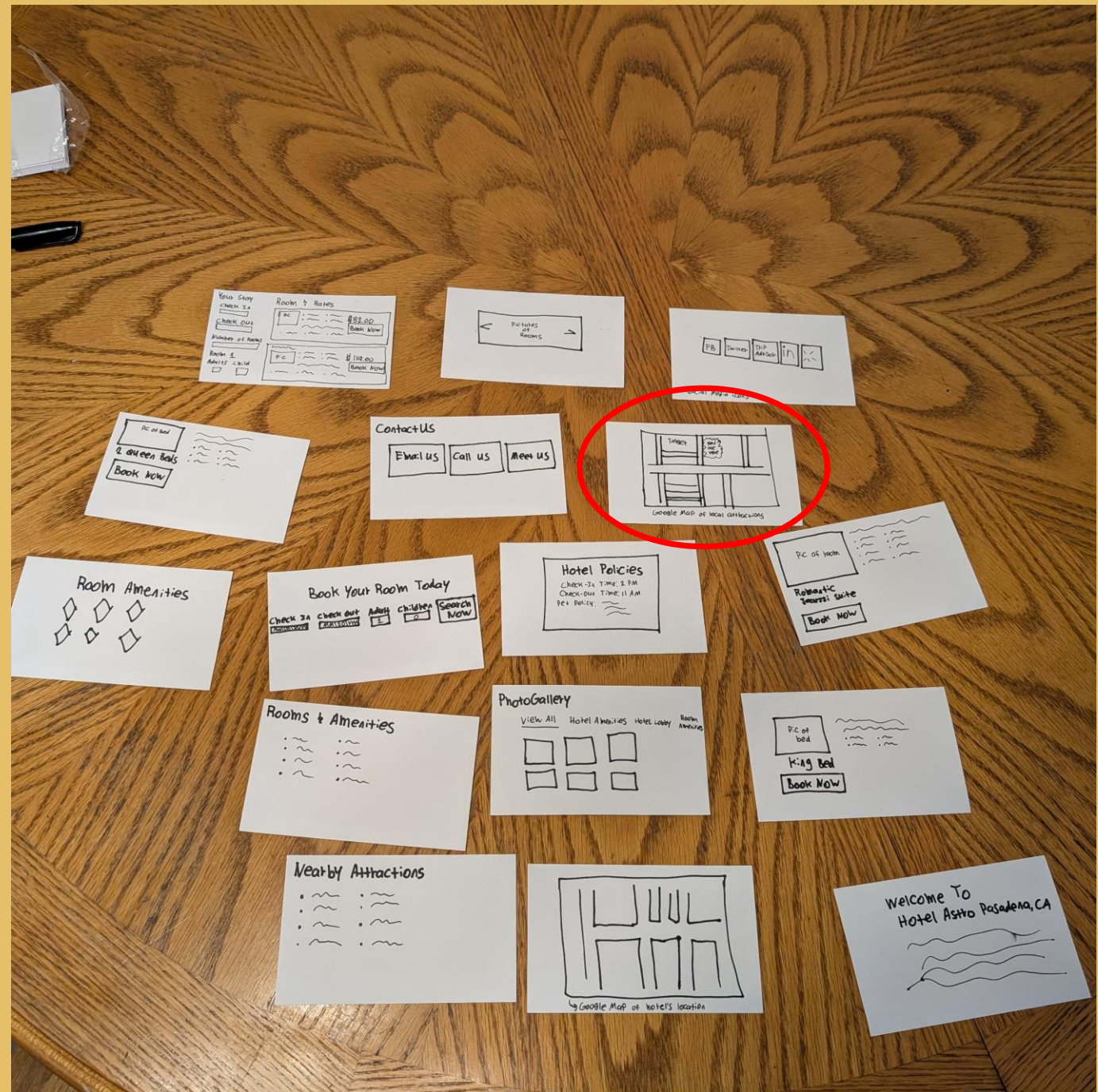
- Users: Alex & Mikey
- Format: Open and Closed
- Goal: Explore user's mental models around features & site navigation; Find out how user's group and organize information
- Research ?: Does Astro's current information architecture make sense?



OPEN CARD SORT

User: Alex

Starting Point

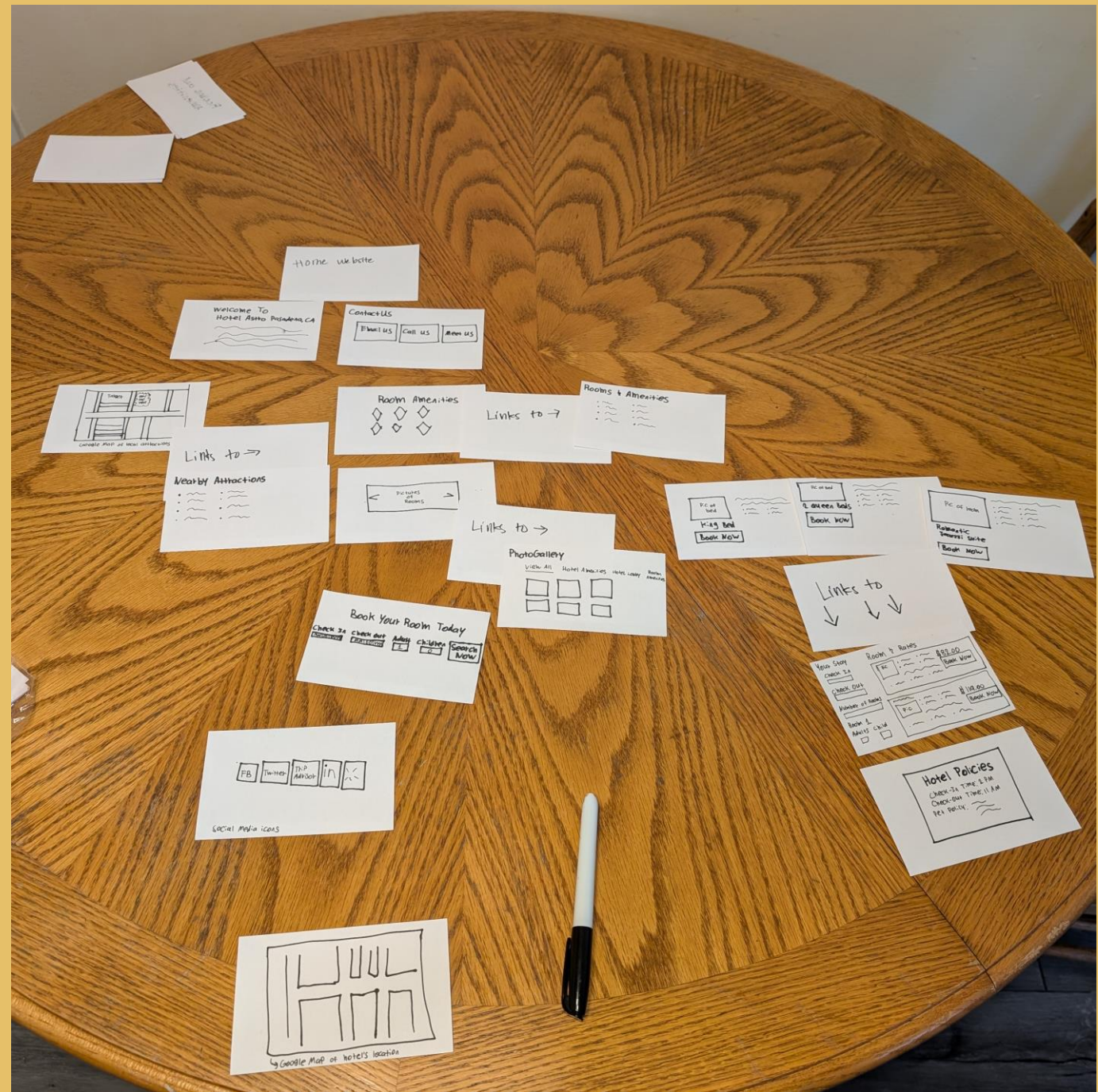


OPEN CARD SORT

User: Alex

Hierarchy of information

Navigation Flow

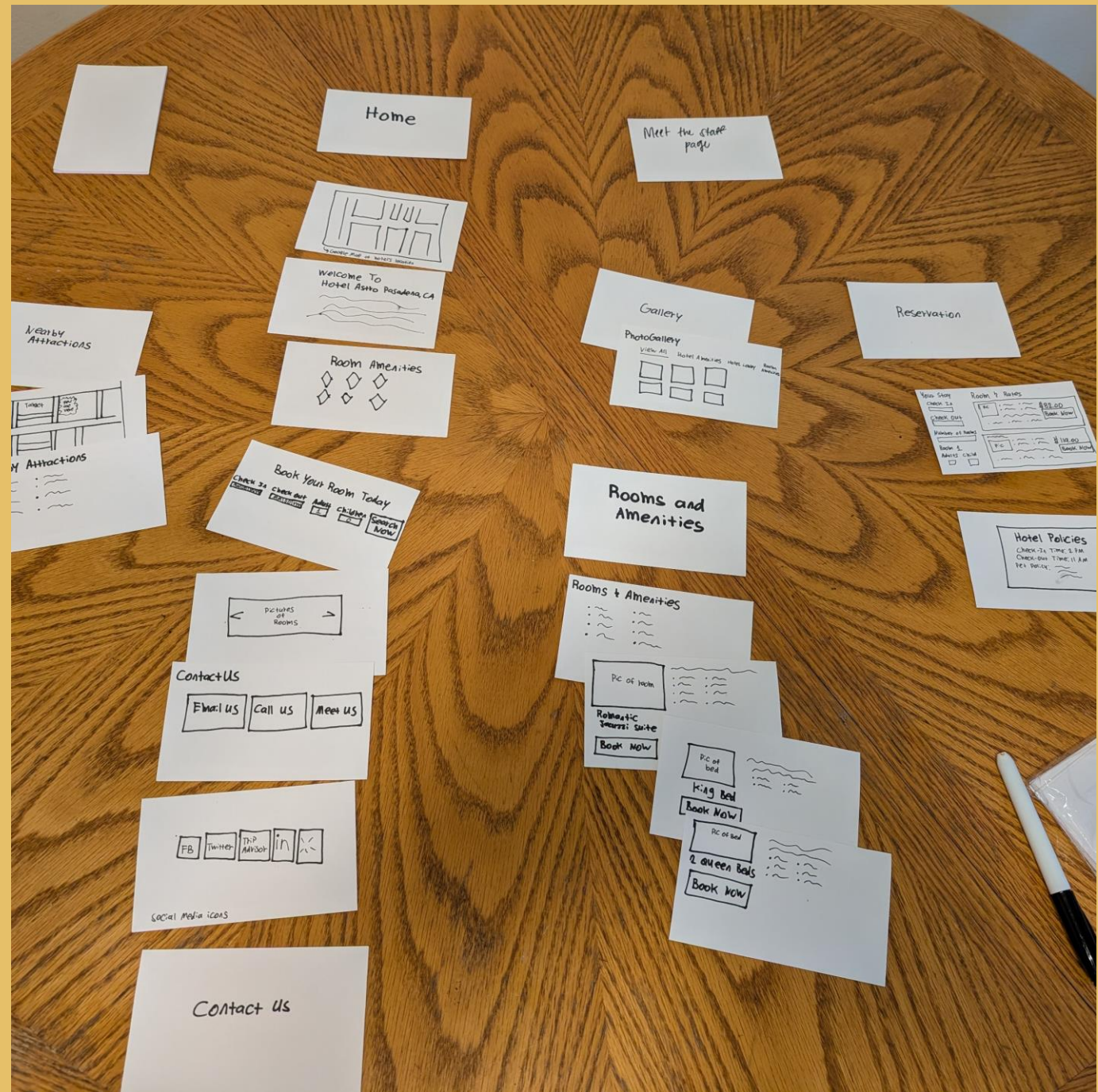


CLOSED CARD SORT

User: Alex

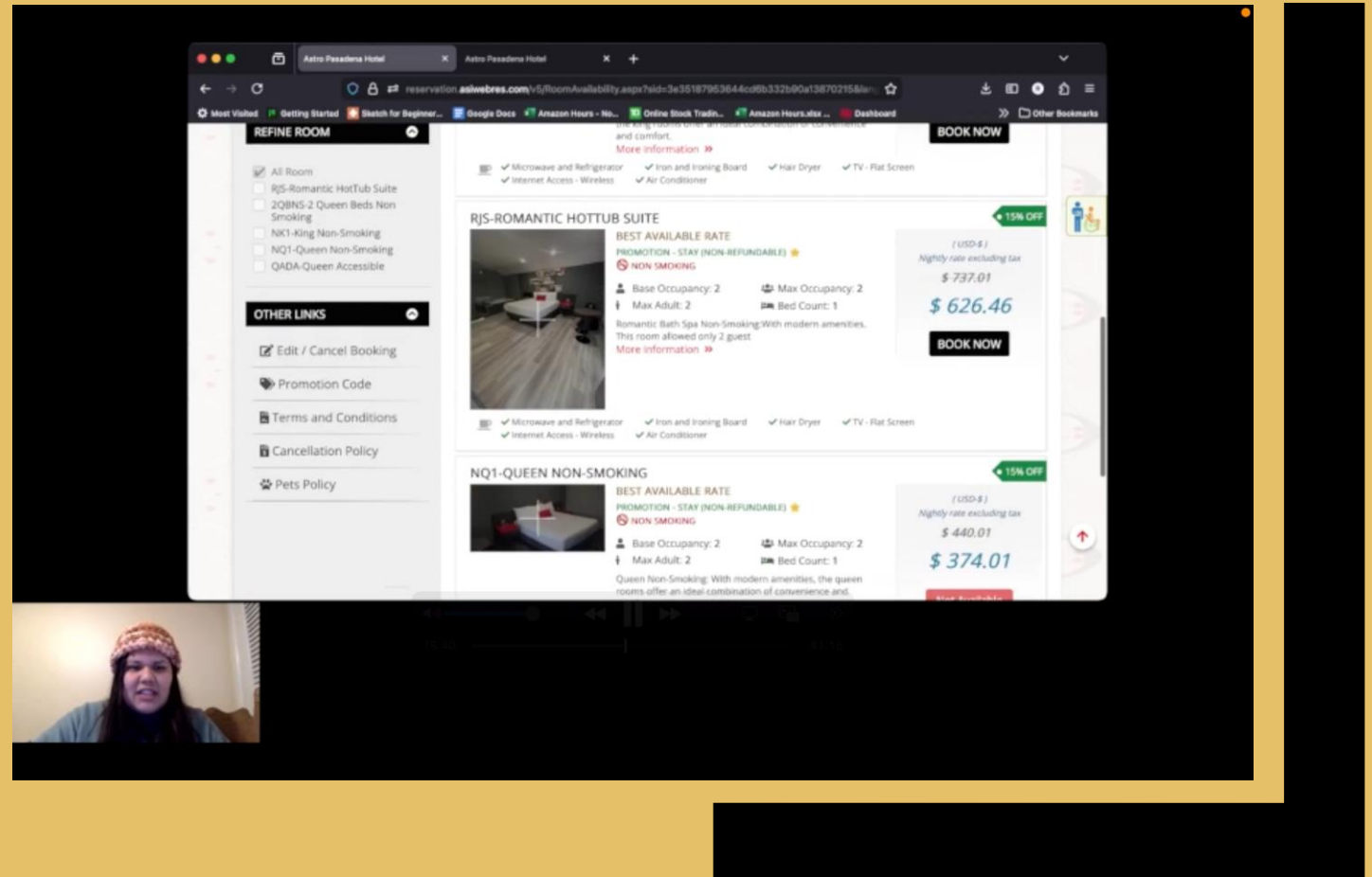
Hierarchy of information

Navigation Flow



NAVIGATION - BOOKING

Navigation Breakdown
Inconsistency



SUGGESTIONS

Be consistent between pages

- 'Other Links' element should be there

Allow for user recovery

- Add a 'Modify' button

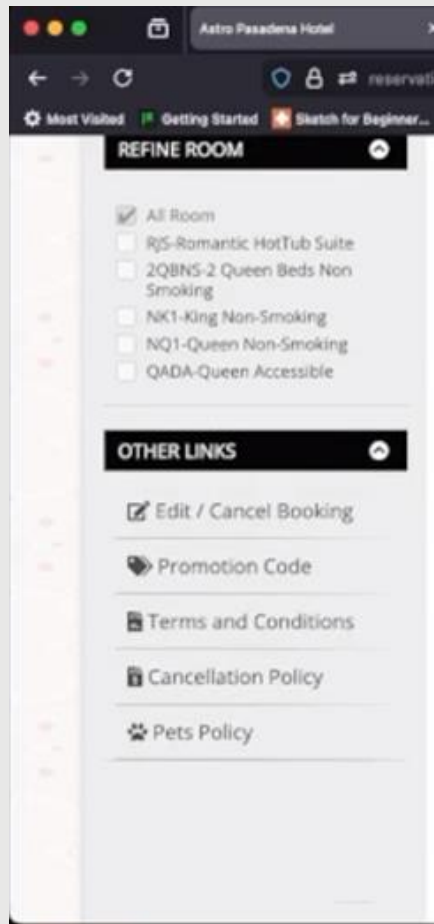


Fig. 1

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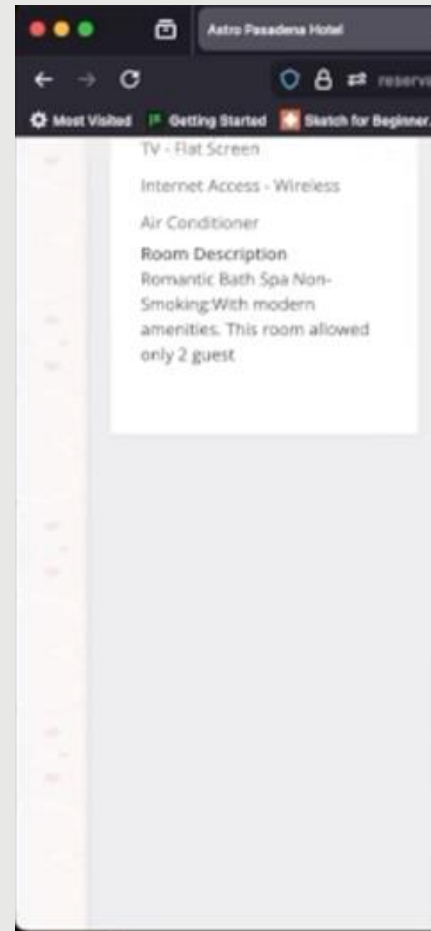


Fig. 2

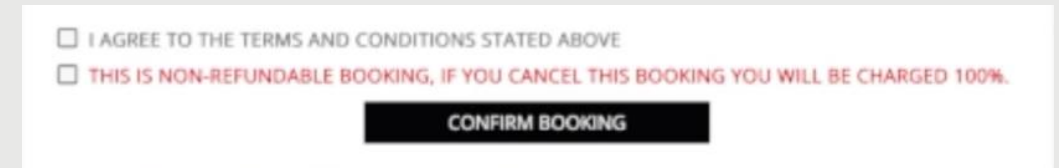


Fig. 3

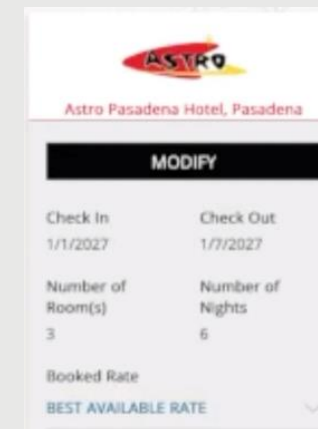


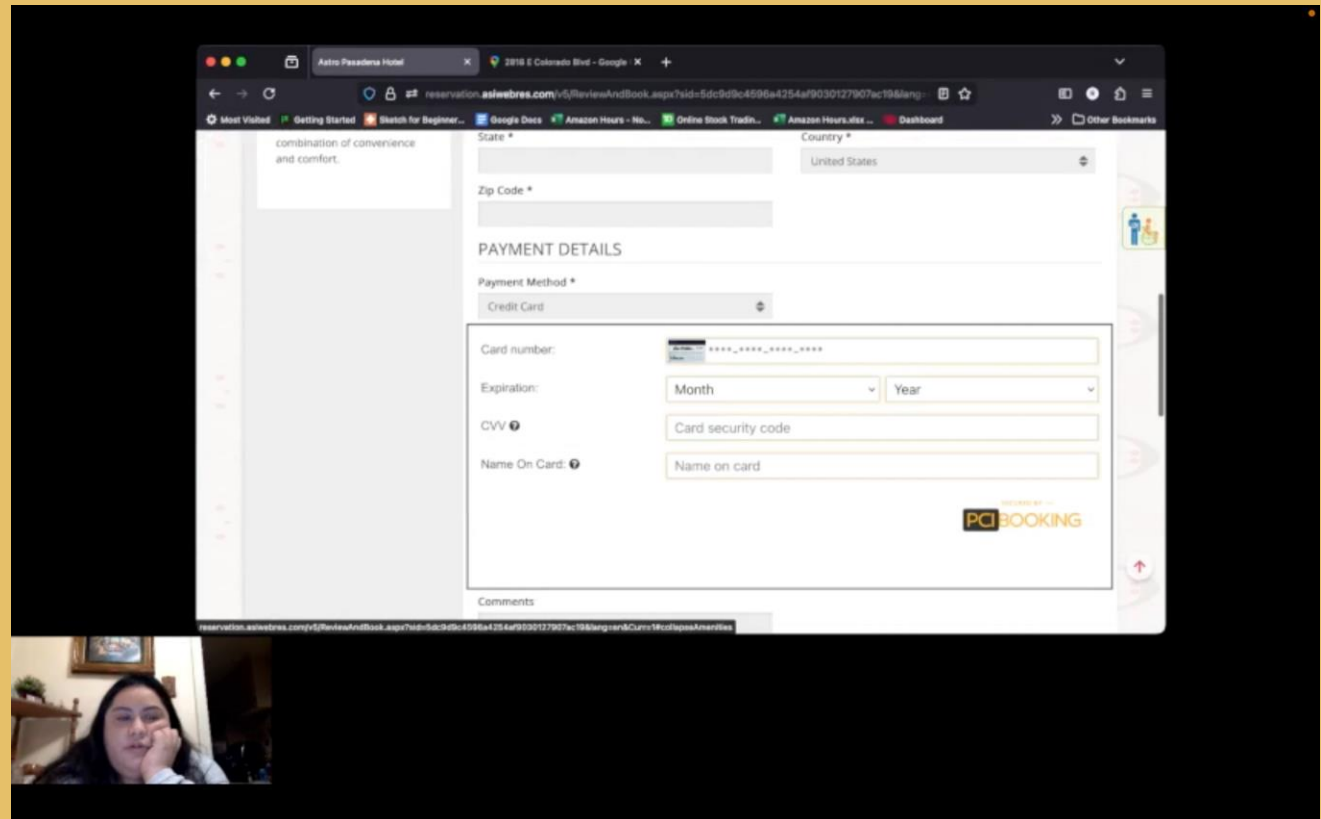
Fig. 4

BOOKING

Mental Model mismatch

Frustrating

Inefficient workflow



“... because that always takes the longest and it’s always the most annoying.”

SUGGESTIONS

Revise booking workflow

- Let users book by room
- Make it easy for families or groups



FOR THE STAY

Language: EnglishYour StaysJoin | Sign In

Your stay Hilton Pasadena

 Sat, Feb 28 – Sun, Mar 1, 2026 (1 night)

 2 rooms for 3 adults and 2 kids

[Edit stay](#)

Room 1 of 2

Select a Room

Room 1

Room 2

Payment

Your stay with Hilton Hotels & Resorts includes

✓ Non-smoking rooms

✓ On-site restaurant

✓ Outdoor pool

✓ Fitness center

✓ Business center

Special rates

☐ Use Points & Money

Filter By:

☐ 1 bed

☐ 2 beds

☐ Suite

☐ Accessible rooms

Daily Mandatory Charge includes: California State Tourism Assessment of 0.195%, Pasadena Tourism Business Improvement District Assessment of 4.89%.

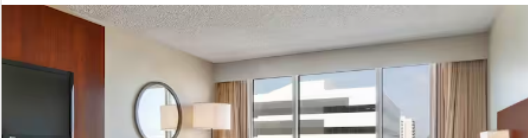
11 rooms found. 4 are currently sold out. We're showing the average price per night.

Prices include fees

Select currency USD - US Dollar

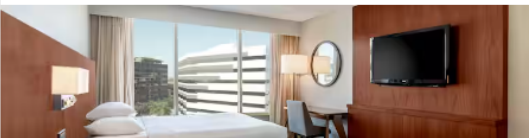
1 King Bed

[View room details](#)



2 Queen Beds

[View room details](#)





Hilton Pasadena

168 South Los Robles Avenue

Pasadena, California 91101 USA

[Hotel details](#)

Reservation summary

Room 1	\$0.00
 2 adults	
Room 2	\$0.00
 1 adult and 2 kids	
Total for stay:	\$0.00

SUGGESTIONS

Revise booking workflow

- Avoid unnecessary repetition
- Make it easy

Hilton

FOR THE STAY

Language: English

Your Stays 

Join | Sign In 

Your stay  Hilton Pasadena

 Sat, Feb 28 – Sun, Mar 1, 2026 (1 night)

 2 rooms for 3 adults and 2 kids [Edit stay](#)

Payment and Guest Details

Total for stay

Total room charge

Total fees

Total taxes

\$466.44

\$398.00

\$20.24

\$48.20

Price in USD

[Show price details](#) 

All fields are required unless marked optional.

 Payment

Card number

Cardholder name

Month

Year

 Guest information

First name



Hilton Pasadena

168 South Los Robles Avenue

Pasadena, California 91101 USA 

[Hotel details](#)

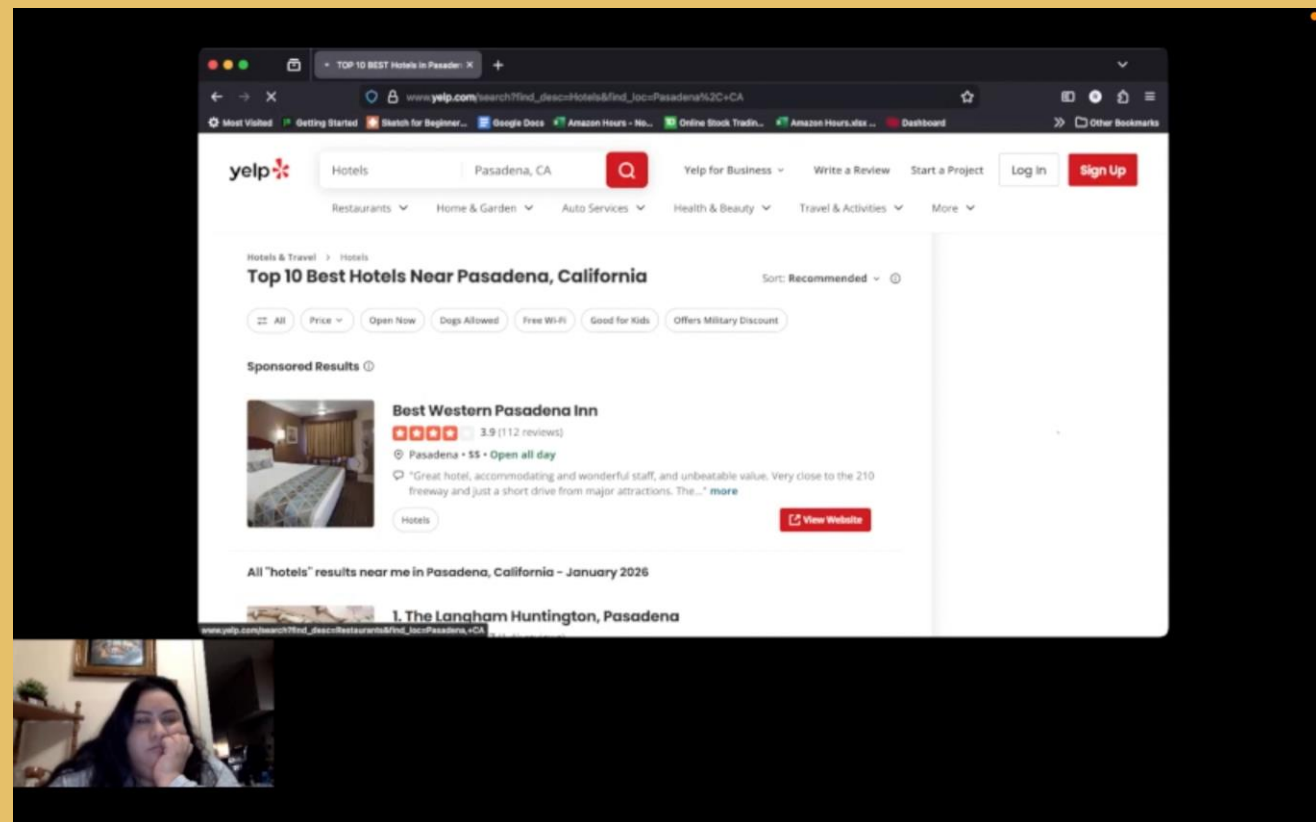


NAVIGATION - REVIEWS

Flow is interrupted

User gets stuck

Unnecessary friction



"I would go straight to Yelp. I wouldn't trust the website."

SUGGESTIONS



Fig. 1: Header

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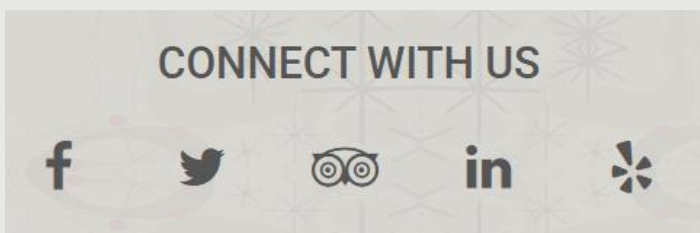


Fig. 2: Footer

Maintain consistency between elements

- Icons should open new tabs (Fig. 1 & 2)

Make it easy for users to find their way back

- You want users on your site (Fig. 3)

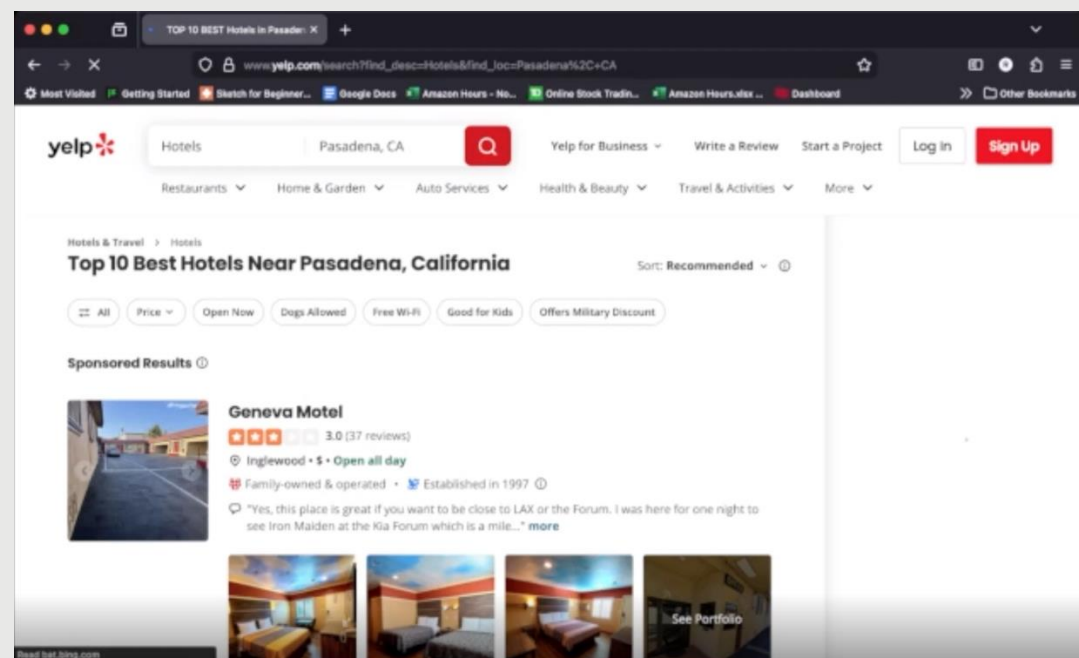
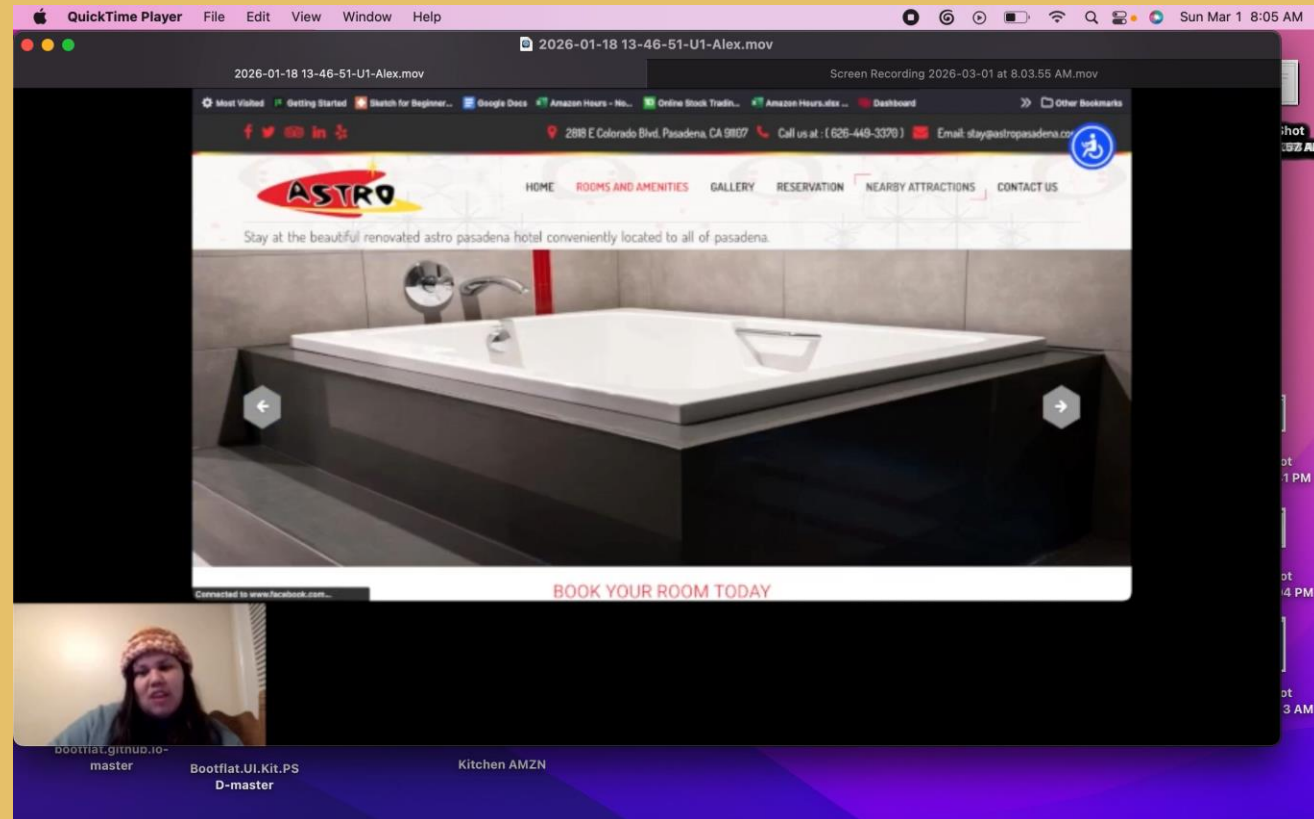


Fig. 3: Suggested hotels are competitors

HEURISTIC INSIGHTS

Match mental models
Support user needs



"... Because now I'm gonna have a separate tab to Google things."

SUGGESTIONS

List Of Attractions In Los Angeles, CA - Welcome Inn

Griffith's Observatory is an incredible free attraction in the city. You can watch a show at the Samuel Oschin Planetarium, spot the sun through a solar telescope, and take part in a guided walk. For our sports fans, be sure to catch a Dodger's game at the Dodger's Stadium. The Santa Monica Pier is famous for its ocean views, delicious churros, street performers, and fun amusement park rides all over the water. Feel like a kid again by visiting Disneyland to meet Mickey and Minnie Mouse. The Hollywood Sign is oh-so-famous, and there are plenty of fun hikes to view it!

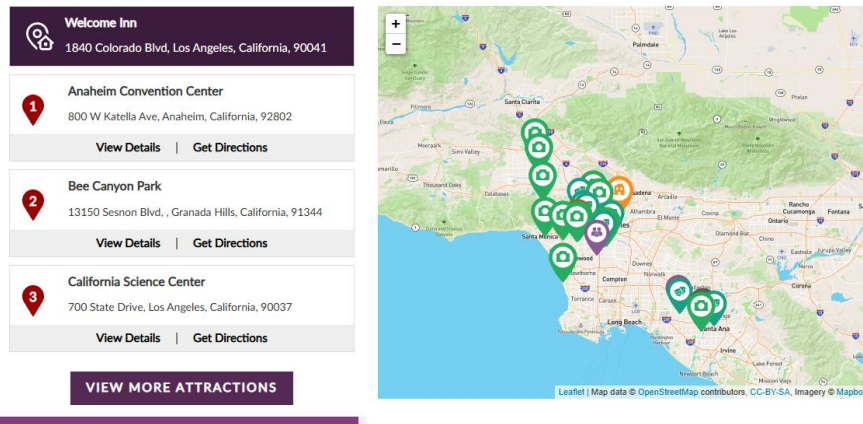


Fig. 1: Map with links and attractions

Provide relevant information

- Users should be well informed (Fig. 1)

Measure distance in a way that is relatable

- Needs to make sense to the user (Fig. 2)

VS

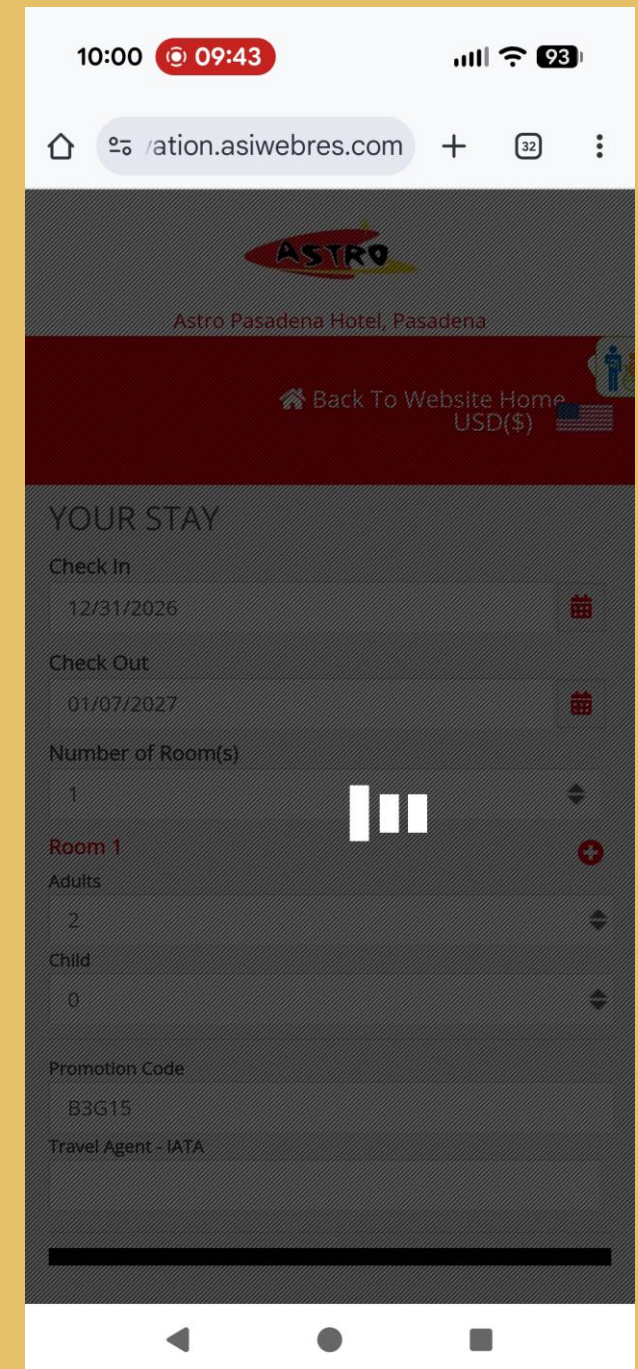
Fig. 2: Information needs context

Nearby Attractions

- ✓ 2 miles from Huntington Library
- ✓ 3 miles from Pasadena Civic Auditorium and Convention Center
- ✓ 3.5 miles from Old Town Pasadena
- ✓ 5 miles from Rose Bowl Pasadena
- ✓ 9 miles from Glendale
- ✓ 13 miles from Dodgers Stadium
- ✓ 13 miles from Los Angeles Convention Center
- ✓ 13 miles from Staples Center
- ✓ 14 miles from Downtown Los Angeles
- ✓ 16 miles to Universal Studios Hollywood
- ✓ 17 miles from Hollywood Chinese Theater and Walk of Fame
- ✓ 18 miles from Burbank/Glendale/Pasadena Airport
- ✓ 23 miles from Rodeo Drive Beverly Hills
- ✓ 28 miles to Getty Center Los Angeles Museum
- ✓ 30 miles from Santa Monica Pier
- ✓ 34 miles to Los Angeles International Airport
- ✓ 39 miles to Six Flags Magic Mountain, Valencia, CA
- ✓ 40 miles to Malibu Beach
- ✓ 130 miles to San Diego, CA
- ✓ 240 miles to Las Vegas, Nevada
- ✓ 380 miles to San Francisco, CA
- ✓ 30 miles to Disneyland Resort Anaheim and Disney California Adventure Park

MOBILE EXPERIENCE

- Mobile site is identical to web (not an app)
- Users successfully navigated around the mobile site and were able to find the information they needed
- Critical Error encountered during Booking task
 - Website crashed during booking process
 - Crash did not let user submit a report
 - User had to exit website and restart



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Booking Process

Should function in a way that makes sense to users

Workflow should support common use cases

Be Consistent, Clear, and Informative

Visualize information (Label pictures)

Hotel policies should be transparent

Navigation

Keep users on site